

There is a limited amount of power in society, which can only be held by one person or group at a time.

- Karl Marx



Power is a relationship in which one group of persons are able to determine the actions of the others in the direction of the former's own end.

- David Easton



Power breeds power and this form the central tenet of elitism.

- Robert Michel

Political Science

The switch from 'Politics' to 'Political Science' occurred as the discipline began to emerge as an autonomous discipline in the modern period. The term politics referred to the affairs of the city state, which was a small community, in the ancient Greece. But the term nowadays refers to as ***Gilchrist*** says, 'current problems of the government'. It means that when someone says he is interested in politics it implies that he is involved in several political activities relating to political issues, legislations, labour issues, party activities and the rest which has far wider canvass. On the other hand, the political studies are distinct and hence they need to be differentiated from current problems. Further, politics in one country differ from the others. What is 'politics' in India may not mean the same in other places. But 'political science' will mean one and the same thing everywhere. Hence it would be better to name the discipline as Political Science than as Politics. The Political Scientists who met at Paris in 1948 also found the term 'Political Science' more acceptable. It is not appropriate to use the two terms as synonyms, though a few still prefer to style the discipline also as politics.

The important developments in Political Science since the time it became a distinct academic discipline occurred in the United States. Until then, Politics was a part of disciplines such as philosophy, law and economics. Political Science as an autonomous discipline dates back to 1880 when ***John W. Burgess*** established a School of Political Science at the Columbia University. By 1920's most of the leading Universities established an exclusive department for the study of Political Science. The American Political Scientists showed tremendous interest in this direction and took efforts to separate it from history, law and philosophy. The discipline then had very formalistic and institutional approach and this trend continued up to the Second World War.

But later, scholars such as ***Woodrow Wilson*** and ***Frank Goodnow*** stressed more on the study of social facts over the study of static institutions. There was a conscious effort by scientists such as ***Arthur Bentley*** to develop an objective, value-free analysis of politics and the principle impetus in this regard came during the 1920's from the Chicago University. ***Charles E. Merriam*** was the leading figure in this movement for empirical observation and measurement in political analysis.

11th Std Political Science Eng Medium Vol-1 Page 001-022 Chapter 1.indd 4 07/12/2022 17:27:34